

Movement Basics

Your map for Module 3 · Exercise and Movement · Move with joy, not grind

Read this page first: safety

- Check with your doctor before starting if you have a heart, joint, back or pelvic condition, an injury, high blood pressure, or if you are already pregnant or in fertility treatment (clinics often advise gentler movement around procedures).
- Stop for sharp pain, chest pain, dizziness, or breathlessness that doesn't settle. Dull muscle ache a day later is normal.
- Breathe out on effort; never hold your breath.
- Moderate means you can talk but not sing. That is the pace for everything in this module.
- Rest is part of the plan, not a failure of it.

Why gentle, regular movement (the science)

- Moderate activity was associated with better odds of conception at every body size; more than 5 hours a week of *vigorous* exercise was associated with lower odds in normal-weight women (Wise et al., *Fertility and Sterility*, 2012).
- Exercise improves ovulation and insulin resistance in PCOS (Harrison et al., *Human Reproduction Update*); Endocrine Society PCOS guideline puts lifestyle first.
- Sustained aerobic activity releases endorphins (Boecker et al., *Cerebral Cortex*).
- Cortisol rises steeply above roughly 60% of maximum effort (Hill et al., *Journal of Endocrinological Investigation*); below that line movement relieves stress.
- Energy deficiency from hard training suppresses reproductive hormones (IOC consensus on RED-S, *British Journal of Sports Medicine*).
- Sleep rebuilds hormones: sleep disruption is linked to menstrual irregularity (Kloss et al., *Sleep Medicine Reviews*); men sleeping 7–7.5 h had the best semen quality (Chen et al., *Fertility and Sterility*, 2016).

The weekly minimums

WHAT	HOW MUCH	SOURCE
Moderate movement (walk, cycle, swim, dance)	150 minutes a week, spread over most days	ACSM position stand (Garber et al., <i>MSSE</i>)
Strength, all major muscle groups	2 sessions a week, a day apart	ACSM
Sleep	7–9 hours, consistent bedtime	CDC / AASM
Rest day	1 full day a week	Training 5

Module 3 at a glance

TRAINING	RUNTIME	RESOURCE	ACTIONS (XP)	TOTAL
T1 · Gentle Yoga for Fertility (guided)	15	Yoga Pose Guide.pdf	Practice 1 session 40 · Journal 30 · Share photo 20	90
T2 · Walking Routines for Couples	8	Walking Tracker.pdf	Walk 3× 40 · Track 30	70
T3 · Strength Training Basics (demo)	12	Strength Routine.pdf	3 exercises 50 · Log 30 · Share 20	100
T4 · Cardio Without Burnout	10	Cardio Log.xlsx	15-min session 40 · Log energy 30	70
T5 · Rest and Recovery Practices	9	Recovery Journal.pdf	Track sleep 40 · 1 technique 30 · Share 20	90
T6 · Movement Weekly Challenge	11	Weekly Planner.xlsx	Complete plan 50 · Reflect 30	80
Module completion bonus				10

Your "why" for this module

"I move my body because, for my future family, I want _____."

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.